

Project Chroma: Game Design Proposal

Team Information

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1 High-Level Concept

The proposed game is a 2.5D action game inspired by the isometric presentation and fast-paced nature of *Brawl Stars*. It is built entirely around a deeply integrated colour-based combat system. Players must manage a limited set of coloured laser shots, strategically applying them against enemies composed of six primary and secondary colours (Red, Green, Blue, Cyan, Magenta, Yellow). The game introduces mechanics gradually—starting from simple colour matching to advanced concepts like Invert Frames and Orb crafting—culminating in a robust puzzle-action experience navigated via a comic-strip style menu.

2 Core Gameplay Loop & Ammunition

The core loop consists of: **Spawn** → **Fight coloured enemies** → **Manage laser shots** → **Collect/create Orbs** → **Refill** → **Complete level** → **Progress via comic-strip menu**.

Ammunition is highly restricted. Players start levels with a specific combination of RGB (Red, Green, Blue) laser shots, constrained by a level cap (e.g., maximum X shots of one kind, $6X$ shots total). Upon depleting ammo, players must return to a “White Light” spawn point to refill. Because a single correct laser shot kills a normal enemy, combat is a deliberate puzzle of resource management rather than mindless shooting.

3 Colour System and Combat Mechanics

Enemies are defined by their base colour and visually carry another colour as a band, signaling drop interactions. The interaction between the enemy's colour and the player's laser shot defines the outcome.

When an enemy dies from the correct corresponding shot (e.g., a Red enemy hit by a Cyan laser), a comic-style death effect (e.g., KAABOOM, 1CO) is triggered.

Red Enemy Interaction		Cyan Enemy Interaction	
Laser Shot	Result	Laser Shot	Result
Red	No change	Red	Dies
Green	Turns Yellow	Green	No change
Blue	Turns Magenta	Blue	No change
Cyan	Dies	Cyan	No change
Magenta	No change	Magenta	Turns Blue
Yellow	No change	Yellow	Turns Green

Table 1: Examples of how varying laser shots affect different enemy types.

4 The Orb System and Laser Crafting

Orbs are a vital part of the ammunition-generation system, allowing players to access laser colours they did not initially spawn with. Certain enemy deaths drop specific Orbs (e.g., Magenta enemy yields a Green Orb; Yellow yields a Blue Orb; Cyan yields a Red Orb).

Players can shoot these Orbs with specific lasers to synthesize new ammunition:

- **Green Orb + Red Laser Shot → Yellow Laser Shot**
- **Green Orb + Blue Laser Shot → Cyan Laser Shot**

Additionally, levels feature **Special Walls**, unlocked later in the game. Shooting a Cyan, Yellow, or Magenta laser at a Special Wall converts that shot into a corresponding Orb (e.g., Cyan Laser → Cyan Orb), providing an environmental method for resource generation.

5 Invert Frame

Introduced in pre-boss levels, “Invert Frame” is a temporary state that fundamentally alters combat rules. During an Invert Frame, the standard complementary colour interactions are disabled. Instead, enemies must be defeated using a laser shot of their *exact same colour* (e.g., a Red enemy requires a Red laser).

Orb drops also adapt to this inversion (e.g., a Cyan enemy will drop a Cyan Orb). Initially an environmental hazard, control over activating the Invert Frame is eventually granted to the player as an unlockable ability with a cooldown.

6 Bosses, Progression, and the Final Reveal

The game’s narrative and mechanical progression is anchored by its bosses and the comic-strip level structure.

The Black Boss

The player first faces the Black Boss, presented initially as the primary antagonist. Defeating the Black Boss acts as a major mechanical pivot, unlocking:

- **White Laser Shots:** Crafted by combining Orbs and Lasers (e.g., Red Orb + Cyan Laser Shot → White Laser Shot).
- **Controlled Invert Frame:** The ability to trigger Invert Frames on command.

- **Special Wall Ability:** The ability to convert lasers into Orbs using environmental walls.

The True Main Boss (White Boss)

Following the defeat of the Black Boss, the comic-strip menu expands, adding three new strips. Players face more Black Boss iterations, forcing them to utilize their newly acquired Special Wall and Invert Frame abilities.

In the final level, the true main antagonist is revealed: **The White Boss**. The White Boss serves as the ultimate test of the game's interlocking systems. To secure victory, the player must simultaneously activate the **Invert Frame** and strike the boss with **20 White Laser Shots**.

7 Summary of Mechanical Progression

The game operates on a meticulously layered progression curve: RGB Lasers → Colour-Based Interactions → Enemy State Changes → Orb Drops → Ammo Conversions → Black Boss Fight → Special Wall Unlocks → Controlled Invert Frame → White Laser Crafting → White Boss Reveal → Final Invert Frame + White Laser execution.

This strict mechanical scaffolding guarantees that players master every facet of the colour combat system before the final confrontation.